26900208 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours) REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026

Fifth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCENG300 - AMERICAN LITERATURE

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. What is the source of self-approval, according to Mark Twain? [K] / [CO1]

   a). Rational thinking

   b). Personal experiences

   c). Common sense

   d). The approval of others

2. The Harlem Renaissance mainly took place during the __. [K] / [CO1]

   a). 1900s b). 1910s

   c). 1920s d). 1930s

3. Booker T. Washington was told that the first thing a deserted soldier did to a black boy was __. [K] / [CO1]

a). kidnap him

b). cut off his ear

c). kill him

d). whip him

4. In “pity this busy monster, manunkind,” the phrase “the bigness of his littleness” criticises: [U] / [CO2]

a). Human modesty

b). Human generosity

c). Human arrogance despite real insignificance

d). Human curiosity

5. What does Dickinson suggest about nature and the external world in the opening stanza of “The Last Night that She Lived”? [U] / [CO2]

a). Nature stops entirely

b). Nature continues unchanged despite the human event

c). Nature visibly mourns the dying woman

d). Nature becomes violent

6. Why is the word “mending” in the title of Frost’s “Mending Wall” considered ironic? [U] / [CO2]

a). Because the neighbours never actually repair the wall

b). Because the neighbours cooperate physically while the wall keeps them emotionally apart

c). Because mending means destroying

d). Because the title has no connection to the poem’s content

7. The phrase "he was a civilian, if one might judge from his habit, who was at heart a soldier" is an example of: [E] / [CO3]

a). Foreshadowing his eventual fate.

b). Direct characterization that explains his motivation.

c). Symbolism of his conflicted nature.

d). A metaphor for the Civil War itself.

8. Which interpretation most convincingly evaluates the story's title? [E] / [CO3]

a). It refers only to a medical condition

b). It links bodily sound with concealed guilt and psychological exposure

c). It refers to the police officers' uniforms

d). It celebrates violence

9. Why does Bierce include Part II, which breaks away from the immediate scene at the bridge? [E] / [CO3]

a). To provide the historical context and personal background necessary to understand Farquhar's crime and motive.

b). To confuse the reader about the timeline of events.

c). To describe the life of the Union scout.

d). To prove that Farquhar was innocent.

10. Which of the following is not a theme of 'All My Sons'? [An] / [CO4]

a). Prostitution b). War

c). Guilt d). Hypocrisy

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

11. Why does Emerson consider art a form of self-expression? [An] / [CO1]

12. Why does Emerson say that an artist never completely separates himself from his age and country? [An] / [CO1]

13. In Joy Harjo's "Remember," the poem calls plants, trees, and animals "alive poems." In simple words, explain what this comparison suggests about how the poem wants us to see nature. [An] / [CO2]

14. In Hughes's "Harlem," how does the "heavy load" image differ in tone from the earlier images of decay? [A] / [CO2]

15. In Plath’s “Mirror,” what does the phrase “Most of the time” suggest about the mirror’s meditation on the opposite wall? [U] / [CO2]

16. Evaluate whether the narrative convincingly proves that wealth and comfort are inherently destructive to artistic ambition. [E] / [CO3]

17. How does Walker dismantle the traditional binary of "educated vs. uneducated" to suggest that intellectualism can be a form of blindness? [E] / [CO3]

18. Comment on the symbolic significance of Larry's tree. [U] / [CO4]

19. Attempt a character appreciation of Ann Deever. [An] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

20. Examine Booker T. Washington's observations on the relationship between the white and the black people. [An] / [CO1]

21. How do the images of flags, bugles, and flowers in the second stanza of Whitman’s poem reflect the speaker’s inability to accept the Captain’s death? [A] / [CO2]

22. Discuss what has happened to Harry's leg, and how does he explain the cause of his condition. [E] / [CO3]

23. How are women characters represented in 'All My Sons' ? Comment [An] / [CO4]

[15x2 = 30]